PianoLift Reference Guide

Slider reference and a practical workflow for getting good Disklavier performances out of MP3 conversions.

1. Control reference

Control	Range	What it does	When to move it
Velocity floor	1-80	Sets the quietest note the Disklavier will play. Raises the loudness of everything below this level.	Soft passages are inaudible or notes barely move the keys -> r
Velocity ceiling	60-127	Sets the loudest note allowed. Notes above this level are clamped down to it.	Forte passages are too loud or feel harsh -> lower it. Climaxes fe
Dynamics curve (gamma)	0.4-2.0	Reshapes the gap between floor and ceiling. Below 1.0 flattens dynamics (more even), above 1.0	Piece sounds too monotone -> raise above 1.0. Piece feels ju
Timing offset	-500 to +500 ms	Shifts every note and pedal event earlier or later by a fixed amount, without changing anything else.	Piano feels ahead of the vocals/band when played against the
Sustain pedal (CC64)	on / off	Includes or strips the transcribed sustain-pedal (CC64) events.	Piano sounds blurred or muddy in busy passages -> turn off fo

All four controls are download-time only -- they re-render the MIDI from already-transcribed note data, so you can drag sliders and re-download instantly without waiting for separation or transcription to run again.

2. How to get a better result

Before converting: pick forgiving source material

- Piano-forward mixes (piano + vocals, piano ballads, solo piano recordings, hymn arrangements) separate cleanly and transcribe accurately.
- Dense mixes (full rock/pop band, heavy synths, distorted guitar) leak into the piano stem and cause ghost notes -- extra notes that were never played on a piano. These mixes will need more manual tolerance or a different source recording.
- Higher-quality source audio (320kbps MP3 or better, not a YouTube rip re-encoded multiple times) gives the separation model cleaner material to work with.

After converting: judge before you trust it

- **Listen to the 'Extracted piano stem' player first.** This is exactly what the transcription model heard. If it sounds clean, the MIDI will likely be accurate. If you hear vocal artifacts, cymbal bleed, or guitar leaking through, expect extra or wrong notes in the MIDI.
- **Scan the piano roll visually.** Wide bands of near-random single-frame notes scattered outside the melodic line usually indicate bleed from another instrument, not real piano content.
- **Listen to the accompaniment player.** Confirm the piano is actually gone and the vocals/other instruments are intact before using it for playback with the real piano.

Tuning dynamics and pedal

- Start with the defaults (floor 20, ceiling 112, gamma 1.0, pedal on) and listen on the actual Disklavier -- headphones or laptop speakers will not tell you how it feels in the room.
- Adjust floor/ceiling first to fit the room and the piece's overall loudness, then use gamma only if the internal dynamic contrast (soft vs. loud within the piece) still feels wrong.
- If a song has one section that is way too loud or soft relative to the rest, that is usually a transcription-confidence issue in a busy passage, not something the sliders can fully fix -- note it and move on rather than over-tuning.
- Turn pedal off temporarily when judging note accuracy on the piano roll or by ear -- sustain can mask timing/dynamics problems that are easier to hear dry.

Fixing sync on the Disklavier

- Start the MIDI and the accompaniment MP3 at the same instant. Both share a zero-aligned timeline (second 0 = second 0 of the original recording), so any drift you hear is a real timing offset, not a sync bug.
- If the piano consistently plays notes before the vocals/band arrive, nudge the timing offset negative (piano plays later). If it lags, nudge positive.
- Change the offset in small steps (50-100 ms), re-download, and re-test on the actual instrument -- perceived timing on a real piano differs from what a waveform comparison shows.

When results are still rough

- Try an alternate recording of the same song (different mix, live album cut, remaster) -- separation quality varies a lot between masters of the same piece.
- A cappella-adjacent or acoustic versions (unplugged, piano+voice only releases) of a song will transcribe far more cleanly than the full studio mix.
- Accept that some songs are simply bad candidates -- heavy synth-pop or wall-of-sound production will not yield a clean piano transcription no matter how the sliders are set.
